

Stats for Sociologists

Course: SOC6302H1F

Instructor: Professor Pepin

Date: October 21, 2025

INSTRUCTIONS:

Fill out the first page of the scantron. Confirm you have included:

- The form code (A or B)
- Your student number (write the number and fill in the ovals)
- Your surname and first initial (write the letters and fill in the ovals)

1. Which command installs a new package in R?
 - (a) `require()`
 - (b) `install.packages()`
 - (c) `load()`
 - (d) `library()`
2. The level of measurement for the `hapmar` variable is _____.
 [1] "Happiness of marriage" [1] "very happy" "pretty happy" "not too happy"
 - (a) dichotomous
 - (b) ordinal
 - (c) nominal
 - (d) interval
3. What does the `::` operator do in R?
 - (a) Comments out a line of code
 - (b) Assigns a value to a variable
 - (c) Specifies a function from a particular package (without loading it)
 - (d) Imports all functions from a package
4. In order to compare meaningfully across groups, a frequency should be converted into a/an _____.
 - (a) percentage
 - (b) ordinal variable
 - (c) standard deviation
 - (d) number
5. Which function is used to load a package in R?
 - (a) `library()`
 - (b) `load()`
 - (c) `install.packages()`
 - (d) `source()`
6. Which RStudio pane is used to write and edit R scripts and Quarto documents?
 - (a) Files
 - (b) Source
 - (c) Console
 - (d) Environment
7. What is Wheelan's primary message of Chapter 1 ("What's the Point?") in *Naked Statistics: Stripping the Dread from the Data*?
 - (a) Statistics provide honest answers to complex questions
 - (b) Statistical formulas are the most important part of understanding data
 - (c) Statistics explain why relationships exist between variables
 - (d) Statistics simplify complex information to help us make better decisions
8. What will happen if you try to use a function from a package that hasn't been loaded?
 - (a) R will automatically load the package
 - (b) You will get an error saying the function is not found
 - (c) R will prompt you to install the package
 - (d) The function will run normally
9. What does Oscar Gandy suggest about the use of racial statistics?
 - (a) Their use in data journalism helps mitigate online polarization
 - (b) They are neutral tools most useful for academic research
 - (c) Their use in legal proceedings increasingly lead to unfair policy outcomes
 - (d) They can both expose and perpetuate discrimination

1. (a) ☐ (b) ☒ (c) ☐ (d) ☐
2. (a) ☐ (b) ☒ (c) ☐ (d) ☐
3. (a) ☐ (b) ☐ (c) ☒ (d) ☐
4. (a) ☒ (b) ☐ (c) ☐ (d) ☐
5. (a) ☒ (b) ☐ (c) ☐ (d) ☐
6. (a) ☐ (b) ☒ (c) ☐ (d) ☐
7. (a) ☐ (b) ☐ (c) ☐ (d) ☒
8. (a) ☐ (b) ☒ (c) ☐ (d) ☐
9. (a) ☐ (b) ☐ (c) ☐ (d) ☒